

Board 1

South Deals
None Vul

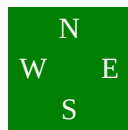
♠ 8 6 5 3
♥ J 10 9 3
♦ 6 2
♣ 9 7 4

♠ 9

♥ A Q 5

♦ A J 10 8 5 3

♣ K J 6



♠ K Q 10 4 2

♥ K 8 2

♦ 4

♣ 10 8 5 3

♠ A J 7

♥ 7 6 4

♦ K Q 9 7

♣ A Q 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♦
Pass	4♥	Pass	4♠
Pass	6♦		
All Pass			
6♦ by North			

With 17 points and a 6-card suit you are definitely thinking about slam. The way to suggest slam to partner is to jump in a suit, so you bid 3♦.

Partner says 4♦, bypassing 3NT and agreeing to your suit;

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Typically you start showing controls, up the line. So you bid 4♥, showing the ♥A. Partner then bids 4♠.

When partner shows first round ♠ control you know you don't have two quick losers, so you bid 6♦.

North plays 6♦. East leads the ♠K. You win East's opening lead with dummy's ♠A.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 2

You only have one too many losers, and you have a very obvious finesse for the ♥K. But first you pull trumps in two rounds. Do you take the ♥ finesse now?

No you don't. In fact you won't need to take it at all, not with that very valuable ♠J in dummy.

Play a ♣ to dummy's ♣Q, then ruff the ♠7 in your hand. Next play ♣K, then another ♣ to dummy's ♣A. Play the ♠J from dummy and discard your ♥5. East will win this trick, (from the opening lead you knew he had the ♠Q), but he will be end-played. A ♠ or a ♣ will give you a ruff/sluff, but a ♥ will give you a free finesse into your ♥A Q.

There is no doubt that a finesse will save a contract for you sometimes.

Sometimes being about 50% of the time on average.

So whenever you see your contract depending on a finesse, just look again and see if perhaps an elimination play is available.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 4 2

♥ 10 3

♦ 10 9

♣ J 10 9 8 4

♠ A Q 6

♥ 4 2

♦ K J 5 4

♣ K 7 3 2



♠ K 7 3

♥ Q J 9 8 6 5

♦ Q 8 6 2

♣ -

♠ 10 8 5

♥ A K 7

♦ A 7 3

♣ A Q 6 5

West

North

East

South

2♥

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

♣A . . . and East discards a ♦!

Over an opponent's Weak 2-bid a 2NT overcall is used to show basically the same as a 1NT opening bid, but promising stopper(s) in their suit.

Partner bids 3NT.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♥10. As expected, West leads his partner's ♥ suit.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 8

You need only one more winner; the best chance will be a 3-2 split in ♣s. But if that doesn't happen you might have to try the finesse in either ♠s or ♦s. The problem is that both finesses go into the East hand. Because of that fact there is no reason to hold up on the first trick so you win the ♥A. Then you play the

Don't be sad that the ♣s didn't split, your contract is now guaranteed! Well, guaranteed as long as East has only a 6-card ♥ suit.

Play your ♥K, and when West follows suit play your ♥7. East wins this trick and he can also win 3 more ♥ tricks. But when he runs out of ♥s he will be forced to play a ♠ or a ♦ because he doesn't have any ♣s. Either one will give you your ninth trick.

If the ♣s had split 4-1 you wouldn't know it until you played a second ♣.

But it wouldn't matter, you would still play the same way. As long as you can strip East of any ♣s you can make the throw-in.